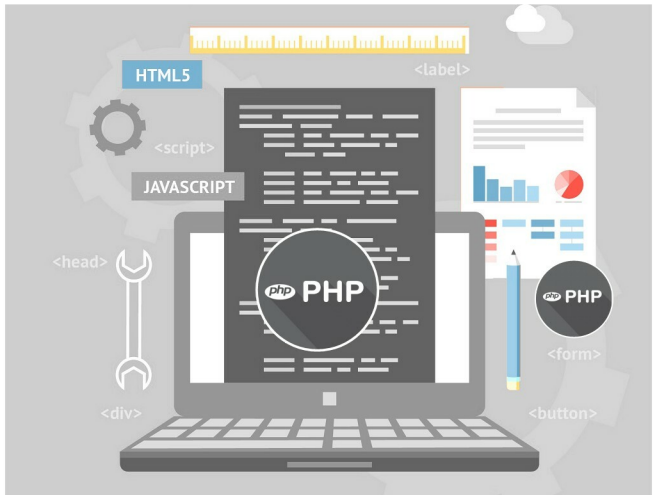


Regular Expressions in Programming Languages: PHP and the Web

This is the fourth article in the series on regular expressions. In the past three articles, we have discussed regular expression styles in Python, Perl and C++. Now, we will explore regular expressions in PHP.



Let me first introduce the PHP environment before discussing regular expressions in it. This basic introduction of PHP will be sufficient even for non-practitioners to try out the regular expressions discussed here. Even if you're not interested in PHP, the regular expressions discussed here will definitely interest you.

So let us start with the expansion of PHP. Earlier, the expansion of PHP was 'Personal Home Page'. But now it has been replaced with the recursive backronym 'PHP: Hypertext Preprocessor'. PHP was developed by Rasmus Lerdorf in 1994, and now the PHP development team is responsible for producing the PHP reference implementation. The standard PHP interpreter is free software released under the PHP

License. PHP can be called a general-purpose programming language but it is mostly used for Web development as a server-side scripting language. The latest version is PHP 7.1, which was released in December 2016.

Standalone PHP scripts

PHP is mostly used for server-side scripting. Hence, most of the time you will see PHP scripts embedded inside HTML. I am sure all of you have heard about HTML (Hypertext Markup Language), which is used as a markup language for creating Web pages. Even if you are an absolute beginner in HTML, there's no need to worry. You won't need any specific HTML skills to understand the regular expressions